Dividing the Work

Immersion Week SF · Day 1 · Session 1.3

50

Minutes

You leave with a board and owners

What This Session Covers

01 Inventory the team's real skills

02 Give every step a single owner

03 Run workstreams with Cowork

04 Put the board in GitHub

Who owns which box?

From 1.2 to Now

A map

The path, drawn

vs

A board

The path, assigned

How We Get There

01

Skills

What can we each do

02

Own

One name per step

03

Split

Run them in parallel

04

Board

Issues in GitHub

01

Owners, Not Volunteers

Skills inventory

An honest list of what each person can do unaided.

What Counts as a Skill

Something you have shipped before

A tool you already have access to

A domain you actually know

Say the Quiet Part

What you have never done

What you would need help with

What you would rather not own

Skill to Step

Skill	Steps it fits
Data wrangling	Intake, parse
Prompt design	Score, summarise
Front end	Report, demo
Domain expert	Judging quality

Single owner

One named person accountable for a step being done.

Why Exactly One

Shared	Single
Everyone assumes cover	One person tracking
Nobody watches the clock	One person to ask
Slips found late	Slips found early

Assign Every Step

01 Riskiest first

It gets the best fit

02 Then the rest

Match skill to step

03 Name the gaps

Steps nobody can own

Volunteer or Best Fit

Volunteer	Best fit
Picks what excites them	Picks what they can ship
Learns on your deadline	Learns on the safe step
Risky step goes last	Risky step goes first

When Nobody Can Own a Step

Stub it and move on

Buy it with an existing tool

Cut it from the happy path

"One name per box, or no name at all."

- The rule that survives Day 2

Roles Beyond Writing Code

Role	What they do
Owner	Holds the problem
Tester	Breaks it on purpose
Scribe	Keeps the Project current
Demo	Tells the story Friday

02

Work in Parallel

Claude Cowork

Claude running multi-step work on files you choose.

Queue or Parallel

Queue	Parallel
One step at a time	Streams run at once
Everyone waits on one	Waiting is designed out
Day 2 runs out	Day 2 finishes

What Cowork Runs

On your files

Reads and edits what you pick

Multi-step

Finishes a task, not a reply

Alongside you

You work while it works

Set Up a Workstream

01 One step only

Scope it to a single box

02 Give the contract

Its input and output

03 Say done

How it proves it worked

A Workstream Brief

Step: Parse resumes to text

Input: PDF files in /intake
Output: one JSON per file
{name, skills[], years}

Done when: 10 sample files parse with no manual fixes.

The contract

The agreed shape passed between two steps.

Agree Contracts First

Name every field you pass

Decide it before building

Write it on the diagram

Step to Contract

Handoff	What passes
Intake to parse	File path plus id
Parse to score	JSON with skills
Score to report	Id plus a number

How Streams Collide

Two people edit one file

A contract changed silently

One stream waits on another

Keeping Streams Apart

One owner per file or folder

Change contracts by announcement

Stub what you are waiting on

03

Put It in GitHub

Three Things You Need

A repo

One place the code lives

Issues

One per task, with an owner

Done

How each task proves itself

Stand It Up Now

01 Create the repo

Name it for the problem

02 Add everyone

Write access, today

03 One issue per step

Straight from the map

An Issue, Filled In

Title: Parse resumes to text

Owner: @teammate
Input: PDF files in /intake
Output: one JSON per file

Done when: 10 samples parse with no manual fixes.

Definition of done

A check someone else can run to confirm it works.

A Good Definition of Done

Observable, not felt

Checkable in a minute

Written before the work

Task to Done

Task	Done when
Parse files	10 samples, no fixes
Score match	Ranks a known set right
Build report	One click, no errors

Issue Hygiene

One task, one issue

Close it the moment it is done

Comment when you are blocked

Is This Task Ready?

	Parse	Score	Deploy
Has owner	**Yes**	Yes	Yes
Has contract	Yes	Yes	No
Has done	No	No	No

Ready for Tomorrow When

Every step is an issue

Every issue has one owner

Every issue says done

Contracts are written down

What You Leave With

1

Repo and board

1

Owner per step

0

Unowned tasks

Day 1, Behind You

A precise problem statement

A workflow map, shared

A board with owners

Next: Choosing the Stack

Match each step to a tool

Decide what to stub

Pick retrieval only if needed